

Singapore Permanent Residence (PR) Application Guide & Document Checklist

Metadata & Scope

- **Document Title:** Singapore Permanent Residence (PR) Application Guidelines
- **Issuing Authority:** Immigration & Checkpoints Authority (ICA) / Economic Development Board (EDB)
- **Document Scope:** Covers eligibility criteria, sponsorship rules, Singpass requirements, National Service obligations, processing fees, timelines, and complete document checklists.
- **Applicability:** Foreigners seeking Permanent Residence status in Singapore.

1. Overview & Evaluation Criteria

1.1 PR Status & Key Mandates

- **Definition:** A foreigner granted permanent residence status, allowing indefinite stay in Singapore.
- **Identity Document:** Singapore Blue Identity Card (IC) issued to PRs aged 15 years and above.
- **Travel Requirement:** A valid **Re-Entry Permit (REP)** is mandatory to enter/leave Singapore while retaining PR status.

1.2 ICA Holistic Assessment Factors

- **Evaluation Criteria:** Family ties to Singaporeans, economic contributions, educational qualifications, age, family profile, length of residency, and commitment to integrating and sinking roots in Singapore.
- **Third-Party Agency Disclaimer:** ICA has **no affiliation** with commercial migration consultants or agencies. ICA does not endorse or support external consultancy services.

2. Eligibility Categories & Sponsorship Rules

2.1 Family & Sponsorship Schemes

- **Spouse of a Singapore Citizen or PR:**
 - **Sponsor:** Citizen or PR Spouse.
 - **Submission Channel:** Sponsor logs in to **ICA e-Service** using **Singpass**.
- **Unmarried Child (< 21 years old):**
 - **Eligibility:** Born within legal marriage to, or legally adopted by, a Singapore Citizen or PR.
 - **Sponsor:** Citizen or PR Parent.
 - **Submission Channel:** Parent logs in to **ICA e-Service** using **Singpass**.

- **Aged Parent of a Singapore Citizen:**
 - **Eligibility:** Sponsoring Singapore Citizen child must be at least 21 years old.
 - **Submission Channel:** Sponsoring child logs in to **ICA e-Service** using **Singpass**.

2.2 Economic & Student Schemes

- **Employment Pass (EP) or S Pass Holder:**
 - **Submission Channel:** Applicant logs in directly to **ICA e-Service** using their own **Singpass**.
- **Student Studying in Singapore:**
 - **Eligibility:** Passed at least 1 national examination (PSLE, GCE 'N'/'O'/'A' levels) or enrolled in the Integrated Programme (IP).
 - **Submission Channel (Aged 15 and above):** Submit using own **Singpass** via ICA e-Service.
 - **Submission Channel (Aged below 15):** Submit via the **non-Singpass option** at ICA e-Service.
- **Foreign Investor:**
 - **Scheme:** Global Investor Programme (GIP).
 - **Governing Body:** Singapore Economic Development Board (EDB).

3. Singpass & System Requirements

3.1 Review & Declarations

- **Mandatory Review:** All added applicants must review the application form and submit declarations.
- **Login Protocol:** Access via Singpass or unique credentials provided by ICA (for non-Singpass eligible applicants).
- **Registration Timeline:** Singpass account approval takes **2 to 5 working days**.
- **Best Practice:** Initiate the online application only after all eligible applicants have active Singpass accounts.

4. National Service (NS) Statutory Obligations

4.1 Enlistment Requirements & Rules

- **Governing Legislation:** Enlistment Act 1970.
- **Liability Scope:** All male applicants granted PR as foreign students or under parental sponsorship.
- **Registration Age:** Registration occurs at **16.5 years old**.
- **Enlistment Age:** Full-time NS enlistment occurs at **18 years old** or upon completing pre-tertiary education ('A' Levels, Polytechnic Diploma, or equivalent).
- **University Deferment Policy:** MINDEF **does not grant deferment for university studies**. Studies must be disrupted to serve NS if granted PR during university.
- **Operationally Ready Reserve:** Reserve duty obligations last until age **50** (for Officers) or age **40** (for Other Ranks).

4.2 Legal Penalties & Long-Term Impacts

- **Default Offence Penalties:** Fines up to **S\$10,000**, imprisonment up to **3 years**, or both.
- **Impact of Renouncing PR without Serving NS:** Severe adverse impact on future applications to work, study, or reside in Singapore. Adverse consequences extend to family members' pass renewals, sponsorships, and citizenship applications.
- **Contact Information:** Central Manpower Base (CMPB) — Local: 1800-3676767 | Overseas: +65-65676767 | Email: contact@ns.gov.sg.

5. Processing Time, Fees & Payment Methods

5.1 Processing Timeline

- **Standard Duration:** Approximately **6 months** (provided all documents are in order).
- **Status Checking:** Viewable via **MyICA** or the ICA e-Service portal.

5.2 Fee Schedule

- **Application Processing Fee (At Submission):** **S\$100** per applicant (non-refundable).
- **Entry Permit Fee (At Completion):** **S\$20**.
- **5-Year Re-Entry Permit (REP) Fee (At Completion):** **S\$50**.
- **Singapore Blue Identity Card Fee (At Completion):** **S\$50**.
- **Accepted Payment Modes:** Visa, MasterCard, AMEX, PayNow, or Internet Direct Debit (DBS/POSB, OCBC, UOB, Standard Chartered).

6. Document Checklist Matrix

6.1 Identity & Personal Documents

- **Passport-sized Photograph:**

- **Specifications:** Digital color photo (400x514 pixels), plain white background, taken within recent months, full face without headgear (unless habitual religious/racial custom).
 - **Applicability:** Main Applicant.
- **Passport / Travel Document:**
 - **Applicability:** Main Applicant and Non-Applying Spouse.
- **Birth Certificate / Household Register:**
 - **Applicability:** Main Applicant and Non-Applying Spouse (if birth not registered in Singapore).
- **Adoption Papers:**
 - **Applicability:** Conditional (minor and parent applicants).
- **Change of Name Certificate (Deed Poll / Religious Cert):**
 - **Applicability:** Conditional (Main Applicant and Non-Applying Spouse).

6.2 Marital & Family Status Documents

- **Marriage Certificate:** Required for Main Applicant and Sponsor (if marriage not registered in Singapore).
- **Separation / Divorce Certificates:** Conditional for relevant applicants/sponsors.
- **Death Certificate of Ex-Spouse/Children:** Conditional (if death occurred outside Singapore).
- **Ex-Spouse Consent Letter & Custody Papers:** Conditional for minor applicants under joint custody.

6.3 Education, Employment & Financial Documents

- **Educational Certificates & Transcripts:** Required for Main Applicant, Non-Applying Spouse, and Sponsor.
- **Skill Certificates & Professional Licenses:** Required for Main Applicant, Non-Applying Spouse, and Sponsor.
- **Employment Letter:**

- **Specifications:** Dated within 3 months of online submission; states occupation, employment date, basic & gross monthly salary.
- **Applicability:** Required for Main Applicant, Non-Applying Spouse, and Sponsor.
- **Payslips:** Latest 6 consecutive months required.
- **Income Tax Assessments:** Latest 3 years required if working overseas.
- **Self-Employed Business Documentation:** Latest ACRA Business Registration Certificate, latest 3 years' Balance Sheets, and latest 3 years' Profit & Loss Statements.

6.4 Special Aged Parent Application Requirements

- **Non-Applying Children Documents:** Birth Certificate/Household Register, latest 1 month payslip, and latest income tax assessment (if working overseas).